

ERA

DESIGN BIBLE

**Real football creates the moments.
The player creates what they become.**

A persistent football world built on real football,
where one player shapes one institution across time.

VISION • CONSTITUTION • PLAYER EXPERIENCE • LIVING WORLD • DESIGN METHOD

PREFACE

Purpose of This Bible

This document captures the foundation of the game before individual mechanics are locked. It is not a conventional game design document and it is not a feature list. It exists to preserve the reason the game should exist, the experience it must create, and the laws that every future system must obey.

The central risk is not a shortage of ideas. It is allowing strong ideas to become disconnected features, or allowing the philosophy to promise more than the actual game can deliver. This bible is intended to prevent both.

The internal standard

A mechanic belongs only when it can be traced to the Constitution and to a player experience the game intends to create.

This is a living document. The Constitution should change rarely. Systems, balance and implementation will evolve through playtesting. The emotional promise must remain intact.

How to Read It

- Volume I establishes the thesis and the emotional promise.
- Volume II defines the immutable laws of the game.
- Volume III describes the player experience across minutes, match days, seasons and years.
- Volume IV defines the Living Club: the visual, ambient and responsive world surrounding the fantasy engine.
- Volume V introduces the method that will convert the vision into mechanics without losing coherence.

NAVIGATION

Contents

I	The Thesis	Why this game should exist
II	The Emotional Promise	What the player should feel
III	The Constitution	What the game must always obey
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IX	Immediate Design Agenda	What must be defined next

VOLUME I

The Thesis

Football is shared. What people build from it is their own.

Every weekend, millions of people experience the same football: the same goals, mistakes, breakthroughs, victories and heartbreaks. Reality does not change according to who is watching.

Yet football never produces one uniform experience. Supporters value different players, moments and traditions. Clubs interpret the same reality through different ambitions, cultures and choices. One club sees a young player as the future. Another sees an immediate competitive need. Another is drawn to a star because of what that star represents.

Fantasy football already provides an elegant interface to this shared reality. It turns the performances of individual real footballers into objective scores. But conventional fantasy play largely ends when the points are counted. The next round begins, and little of lasting significance remains.

The game begins at that boundary.

The thesis

Use real football and objective fantasy scoring as the engine of a persistent institution: a club, enterprise and world shaped by one player across many seasons.

Why ERA

The name should not be forced into every description of the game. It belongs at the highest emotional level.

An era is created because the same player remains responsible for the same institution through changing footballers, seasons, victories, failures, fashions and conditions. The continuity of stewardship is what turns separate decisions into a body of work.

The game is played week by week. The institution is built season by season. Only in retrospect does it become an ERA.

Epic usage

Great clubs are remembered through eras. This game lets the player create one.

The Object Being Created

The player is not merely assembling a fantasy lineup. The player is creating a football institution with competitive ambition, an economy, supporters, collections, visual character, traditions and accumulated consequence.

Winning matters greatly. Economic strength matters. Long-term strategy matters. Taste matters. Fandom matters. The institution becomes distinctive through the interaction of all of them, not through history alone.

Two players may use the same footballers and receive the same fantasy points. Their institutions can still become radically different because the same reality is converted into different decisions, investments, attachments and outcomes.

VOLUME II

The Emotional Promise

The game must earn emotional commitment before it asks for long-term commitment. Players should not have to wait months to understand why the institution matters. The immediate session and the multi-year journey must reinforce each other.

The Five Core Emotions

Ownership

This is not ownership of football itself. It is the feeling that the institution, its choices, its spaces and its accumulated meaning could only have been created by this player.

Delight

Every visit should contain something satisfying to see, hear, discover, arrange, collect, anticipate or celebrate. Long-term depth is never an excuse for a dull session.

Competition

Winning should produce real joy, status and economic consequence. The institution is not a decorative sandbox detached from performance.

Attachment

Players should care about footballers, supporters, places and objects because they have lived with them, used them and connected them to memorable moments.

Expression

Taste should emerge through choices rather than through selecting a predefined archetype. The player takes shared football to their own place.

The Promise Across Time

HORIZON	THE PLAYER SHOULD FEEL	THE GAME MUST PROVIDE
Seconds	Visual pleasure and curiosity	Motion, sound, atmosphere, responsive detail
Minutes	Agency and reward	Clear choices, collecting, customization, feedback
Match day	Tension and celebration	Live fantasy scoring, competition, supporter reaction
Season	Progress and consequence	Winning, economy, growth, setbacks, milestones
Years	Pride and authorship	A unique institution, recognizable taste, accumulated stories

VOLUME III

The Constitution

The Constitution defines what the game is. It should remain compact enough to guide decisions and strong enough to reject attractive features that do not belong.

These laws are not marketing lines. Each law creates a design obligation and a test.

1

Reality Is Shared and Immutable

Real football is the common world.

Every player experiences the same matches, footballers and outcomes. The game may interpret reality, but it must never rewrite it.

Design test: Does the feature preserve a single shared football reality for everyone?

2

Fantasy Is the Objective Engine

Fantasy measures football performance; the institution never alters the score.

The scoring system must remain transparent and independent of wealth, upgrades, status or institutional strategy. Civilization can respond to fantasy, but it cannot influence fantasy.

Design test: Could a richer or older institution change the fantasy output of the same real performance? If yes, reject it.

3

The Institution Persists

Footballers, seasons and circumstances change. The institution continues.

Cards and players may enter, contribute and leave. The player remains the steward of one continuing institution, allowing consequence to accumulate across time.

Design test: What remains meaningful after a footballer is sold, transferred or retired?

4

Ownership Emerges Through Decisions and Taste

Shared reality becomes personal through repeated choice.

Players may access the same footballers and outcomes. Their institutions become different through what they value, how they compete, where they invest, what they collect and what they preserve. Identity is not selected; it is recognized later.

Design test: Does the system enable genuine expression, or merely assign a cosmetic label?

5

Performance and Economy Have Real Consequence

Winning matters, and strength must be built.

Competitive results should influence supporters, resources, opportunity and reputation. Losing clubs may retain loyal supporters and emotional meaning, but the game must not pretend that winning and losing are equivalent.

Design test: Does success create meaningful advantage without making long-term recovery impossible?

6

Decisions Compound Without Rewriting the Present**Strategy shapes the future; it does not manipulate objective football today.**

Repeated decisions create capabilities, constraints and institutional character over time. Development should reward the process within the institution, not distort universal prices or retroactively change fantasy results.

Design test: Does the choice create future consequence while respecting shared current reality?

7

Every Session Must Reward Attention**The institution must be enjoyable now, not only meaningful later.**

The world should always offer visual life, atmosphere, discovery, interaction or anticipation. Players should sometimes visit simply because being there feels good.

Design test: What can the player enjoy or notice in this session even without completing a strategic objective?

Supporting Design Principles

- Success is multidimensional, but competitive success remains central.
- Time creates meaning, rarity and attachment; it should not merely create waiting.
- Supporters attach to winning, taste, continuity, fandom and stories in different proportions.
- The economy rewards the process and the institution, not artificial transaction markups.
- The player's decisions shape the future rather than rewrite the present.
- Every important mechanic should generate a player story and a visible world response.
- Richness is a requirement, not a final polish pass.

VOLUME IV

The Experience Architecture

The game operates on several clocks at once. The immediate session must be pleasurable. Match days must be tense. Seasons must create consequence. Years must create authorship.

The Player's Core Loop

1. Observe the living institution and the current football world.
2. Prepare: choose footballers, lineups, investments, collections or priorities.
3. Compete through objective fantasy scoring generated by real football.
4. Experience the result through rewards, losses, supporter reaction and visible change.
5. Reinvest into the institution according to personal strategy and taste.
6. Return to a world that has continued living.

The Four Rhythms

Every Visit

- See what changed
- Enjoy the space
- Collect or customize
- Notice ambient stories
- Make one meaningful choice

Match Day

- Prepare lineups
- Follow real football
- Watch live fantasy scoring
- Compete
- See the club and supporters react

Season

- Chase titles and objectives
- Manage economic trade-offs
- Grow the institution
- Review milestones and failures

- Create new expectations

Multi-Year

- Develop recognizable taste
- Build sustained advantage
- Preserve meaningful objects and moments
- Create a dynasty or recover from decline
- Become known for an era

Player Stories Before Systems

The next phase of design should begin from stories the game must consistently produce. Mechanics are then built as reliable causes of those stories.

- I visited my club for one minute and noticed three things I had never seen before.
- I won a major fantasy competition and watched the entire institution celebrate.
- I stayed with a young footballer through weaker weeks because the long-term institutional value mattered to me.
- I sold a footballer at the same market price as everyone else, but the years I invested still strengthened my institution.
- My real-life club fandom is visible in the objects and atmosphere of my online club.
- A friend understood my football taste within seconds of visiting my institution.
- I lost for a period, but I still cared about the club and wanted to rebuild it.
- After several years, the institution felt like a coherent body of work rather than a stack of upgrades.

VOLUME V

The Living Club

The institution should never feel like a menu. It should feel like a place.

The Living Club is not decorative packaging around the real game. It is one of the game's defining systems. It converts abstract progress, competition, fandom and time into a place the player can observe and enjoy.

The ambition

Players should sometimes open the game with no objective other than to spend a minute in their club.

The World Must Continue Without the Player

The club should appear to have lived between sessions. Staff work. Visitors arrive. Construction advances. Grounds are maintained. Trees grow. Light changes. Weather passes. Supporters gather and disperse. Objects move. Small stories begin and end.

The world should not repeat the same idle loop forever. It should be orchestrated from the institution's state, local time, real football calendar, weather, recent results, construction, collections and supporter profile.

Everyday Life

- Ground staff mowing lawns in visible patterns.
- Gardeners pruning, watering and replacing plants.
- Trees growing slowly across months and responding to season and weather.
- Deliveries, maintenance vehicles and construction crews.
- Supporters visiting the museum, store, plaza and training areas.
- Children playing football, families taking photographs and staff moving between buildings.
- Birds, insects, pets, litter, cleaning and other small environmental details.
- Buildings opening, closing and changing activity according to the hour.

Match-Day Transformation

- Supporters arrive in increasing numbers before kickoff.

- Transport, food stalls, security, flags, music and queues alter the grounds.
- The stadium and surrounding spaces respond live to fantasy events.
- Goals, clean sheets, major mistakes and final results create distinct crowd reactions.
- A major final should feel fundamentally different from an ordinary fixture.
- After the event, crowds leave gradually and the grounds carry visible traces of what happened.

Night

- Floodlights, office windows, pathways and display cases create a different visual composition.
- Security patrols, maintenance work and late visitors replace daytime activity.
- Trophy rooms, statues and museum objects can become focal points through lighting.
- Quiet should feel intentional rather than empty.
- Night events, celebrations and adverse weather can produce rare scenes.

Visible Consequence

SYSTEM STATE	LIVING-WORLD EXPRESSION
Supporter growth	More visitors, fuller transport, queues, banners, denser match-day atmosphere
Economic strength	Maintenance quality, construction tempo, commercial activity, staffing and presentation
Winning	Celebrations, media presence, trophy displays, special lighting, prestige behavior
Losing period	Lower attendance, quieter spaces, protest or concern, but continued loyal presence
Collections	Museum exhibits, statues, murals, club rooms, supporter clothing and commemorative events
Institutional taste	What the club displays, celebrates, preserves and invests attention in

Richness Standard

Richness cannot mean visual noise. It means layered, coherent variation. The player should see a believable combination of macro-state and micro-detail.

- Macro layer: architecture, grounds, supporter density, construction and major events.

- Meso layer: plazas, stores, museums, training areas, traffic, queues and staff activity.
- Micro layer: gestures, conversations, cleaning, plant growth, birds, signage, changing displays and small incidents.
- Temporal layer: time of day, weekday, match schedule, season, weather and recent history.
- Personal layer: fandom, collections, victories, taste, economic choices and long-term strategy.

Non-negotiable

No session should feel visually abandoned. The world may be quiet, but it must never feel dead.

VOLUME VI

Weather, Time and the Real World

The player's real-world location can supply a powerful additional layer of presence. With explicit permission, the game can query current local weather and use it to shape the club environment.

This is not intended as a gimmick or a one-to-one meteorological simulation. It is an experiential bridge: the player's physical day and the institution's day can feel connected.

Local Weather Layer

- Current conditions: clear, cloudy, rain, storms, wind, heat, cold, fog or snow where relevant.
- Temperature and season influence clothing, crowd behavior, vegetation, shade, irrigation and activity.
- Rain changes surfaces, umbrellas, reflections, traffic, groundskeeping and sound.
- Wind affects trees, flags, litter, clothing and stadium atmosphere.
- Sun position and cloud cover alter light, shadow, color and visibility.
- Forecasts can create anticipation: covers placed before rain, watering ahead of heat, early lighting before dark weather.
- Rare local conditions can create memorable scenes without granting competitive advantage.

Time Layer

- Local sunrise and sunset drive natural lighting.
- The club changes between morning, afternoon, evening and night.
- Weekdays, weekends and holidays alter visitor patterns.
- The real football schedule overrides ordinary routines on match days.
- The world should preserve continuity when the player changes device or returns later.

Privacy and Fairness

- Location-based weather must be opt-in and clearly explained.
- The game should request only the level of location precision needed to obtain local conditions.
- Players who decline location access receive a chosen or default weather region.
- Weather should enrich atmosphere and light operational choices, not determine competitive fantasy outcomes.
- Accessibility settings must allow reduction of lightning, heavy motion, sound intensity and visual obstruction.

Weather as Storytelling

Weather becomes meaningful when it meets an event. A storm during a final, a sunset after a championship, rain on a quiet rebuilding week, or the first warm evening of a new season can become part of the player's memory.

Experience rule

The same club should feel meaningfully different at noon, at night, in rain, in heat, before a final and the morning after defeat.

VOLUME VII

AI as a World-Building Capability

AI can make the richness standard economically achievable, but it must serve authored design rather than replace it. The goal is not uncontrolled generation. The goal is scalable variation inside a coherent world.

What AI Can Orchestrate

- Selection and timing of ambient events based on world state.
- Variation in crowd behaviors, clothing, signage, conversations and small incidents.
- Contextual reactions to results, milestones, weather and collections.
- Personalized museum descriptions, club media and commemorative displays.
- Procedural combinations of approved animation, audio and environmental assets.
- Long-tail moments that reduce repetition across thousands of sessions.

What AI Must Not Control

- Fantasy scoring or objective football truth.
- Economic balance without deterministic rules and auditability.
- Competitive outcomes.
- Unreviewed brand, safety or rights-sensitive content.
- Core visual identity without art-direction constraints.

Authored World, Generative Variation

The creative team defines the vocabulary, tone, boundaries and meaning of the world. AI combines and contextualizes approved elements. Important moments remain deliberately directed; everyday life gains breadth and freshness.

AI principle

Use AI to multiply authored richness, not to outsource authorship.

VOLUME VIII

From Vision to Mechanics

The next phase must touch mechanics directly. The purpose of this method is not to delay design. It is to make sure the mechanics are strong enough to carry the promise.

The Design Chain

1. Constitutional law

What must remain true?

2. Desired emotion

What should the player feel?

3. Player story

What should the player later describe?

4. Player verb

What does the player actually do?

5. System rule

How does the game convert action into consequence?

6. Feedback

How does the player understand the result?

7. Living-world expression

How does the institution visibly react?

8. Balance and failure test

Can it be exploited, ignored or made tedious?

Example: Young Footballer Strategy

This example is illustrative, not final balance.

1. Law: fantasy scoring remains objective; decisions compound without changing universal market prices.
2. Emotion: patience, belief and pride.
3. Story: the player retained and repeatedly used a young footballer before he became widely valued.
4. Verb: acquire, select, retain, eventually sell or preserve.
5. System: age, ownership duration, meaningful fantasy use and seasons retained accumulate development history inside the institution.
6. Economic rule: the footballer's universal transaction price remains the same for every player.
7. Institutional consequence: development history strengthens the academy or related institutional capability rather than increasing sale proceeds.
8. Living-world response: academy displays, supporter stories, youth activity, commemorative objects and reputation visibly evolve.

Example: Winning

1. Law: performance and economy have real consequence.
2. Emotion: tension, triumph, momentum and pressure.
3. Story: a major fantasy victory changed what the institution could attempt next.
4. Verb: prepare, select, compete, watch, win, reinvest.
5. System: competitive performance produces rewards, supporter response, reputation and access.
6. Counterweight: success increases expectations and creates more to defend.
7. Living-world response: crowds, media, celebrations, displays and commercial activity change immediately.

Mechanics Must Be Simple to Use, Deep in Combination

The philosophy is sophisticated. The interface cannot require the player to study the philosophy. Players should make understandable choices and experience rich consequences.

Mechanics standard

Simple verbs. Legible rules. Deep combinations. Visible consequences.

VOLUME IX

Immediate Design Agenda

The philosophy is sufficiently defined. The next work should lock the actual game in a deliberate sequence.

1. Define the First 30 Minutes

- What does the player receive?
- What can be seen immediately?
- What is the first meaningful choice?
- What is the first competitive promise?
- What creates delight before any long-term progression exists?

2. Define One Complete Match Week

- Footballer acquisition and availability.
- Lineup construction and competition format.
- Live scoring and opponent visibility.
- Rewards, losses and economic movement.
- Supporter and Living Club reactions.
- What the player does on a day with no match.

3. Define the Institution's Core Resources

- Money and its sources and uses.
- Supporters and the reasons they arrive, stay or leave.
- Institutional capabilities created by investment.
- Collections and their emotional, visual and systemic roles.
- Reputation, status and access.
- What persists permanently and what resets by season.

4. Define Competitive Success

- Primary fantasy competitions.
- Short-session, weekly and seasonal objectives.
- How winning accelerates the institution.

- How losing remains meaningful without being equally rewarding.
- Recovery paths that preserve agency.

5. Prototype the Living Club in Parallel

The Living Club must not be postponed until the systems are complete. A vertical slice should prove that the world can feel alive with limited content before scale is attempted.

- One stadium and surrounding grounds.
- Day, night and one weather condition.
- Ordinary day and match-day population states.
- Visible reaction to one win and one loss.
- A small set of AI-orchestrated ambient events.
- One real-life club collectible displayed in the environment.

Working Questions That Must Be Answered

- What exactly is a player card, and what rights or uses come with owning one?
- How are footballers acquired when everyone can ultimately access the same reality?
- What is scarce: cards, use rights, editions, aesthetics, competition entries, time, or something else?
- What is the simplest fantasy format that can carry the larger institution?
- How does the economy avoid becoming either irrelevant or pay-to-win?
- What do supporters consume, produce and change?
- How do real-life fandom collectibles enter the game legally and meaningfully?
- What can a visitor understand about another institution in ten seconds?
- Which actions create immediate fun on a quiet Tuesday?
- What is the smallest viable version that still feels unmistakably rich?

FINAL

Closing Standard

**The game should be strategically meaningful,
competitively serious and visually irresistible.**

The football must remain real. The fantasy layer must remain objective. The institution must persist. Winning and economy must matter. Taste must emerge through decisions. The world must reward attention in every session.

The ambition is not merely to create another football product. It is to create a place where real football continues beyond the final whistle, where a player's choices accumulate into an institution, and where years of stewardship can eventually be understood as an ERA.

The final test

Would a player return today because the game is fun, and remain for years because the institution became theirs?